# Human development as recursive belief updating

Each consequence becomes the next activating event. Examining a belief produces a revised outlook that later beliefs keep building on.

1

2

3

4

$A_1 \rightarrow B_1 \rightarrow C_1$

$A_2 \rightarrow B_2 \rightarrow C_2$

D

E





**Activating event**

Something happens, such as a tense conversation.

**Belief**

How the event is interpreted in the moment.

**Updated belief**

Shaped by what the first consequence taught.

**Examination**

Question the belief: is it accurate, and is it useful?

**Revised outlook**

A more flexible way to read the next event.



$B_1$

$B_2$

Continuous belief revision

$B_2$ → $B_3$ → $B_4$ …











$C_1$



$C_2$



**Consequence**

The relationship is strained.

**Consequence**

The relationship is repaired.

**Next event**

The first consequence becomes the next thing that happens.

Schematic: the stages and outcomes are illustrative, not measured.

After the ABC model of cognitive-behavioural therapy (A activating event, B belief, C consequence), with D and E shown as examination and revised outlook.